

STAGE TEN • RELATIONSHIPS & CONNECTIONS

FIRSTS

PARTICIPANT PRE-WORK

A short primer to send before each session, so people arrive oriented

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Participant Pre-Work Handout

Stage Ten • Relationships & Connections

FOR FACILITATORS

Send the relevant section below 2-3 days before each session. This stage's pre-work is less about logistics (no devices or accounts needed) and more about arriving with real relationships already in mind — the exercises are far more useful applied to something specific than something hypothetical.

Before Session 1: Friendships & Peer Connections

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring to mind one real friendship you'd genuinely like to invest in more deliberately.
- Bring to mind one real, unaddressed tension in a friendship, if one exists — you won't be asked to share details with the group.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This session is built entirely around real relationships you already have. Arriving with a specific friendship in mind, rather than a hypothetical one, makes every exercise genuinely more useful.

Before Session 2: Project Partners & Teamwork

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Identify one current or upcoming group project you can reference throughout this session, ideally with a real partner or team already in place.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Nearly every exercise this session works better applied to something real and current than something hypothetical.

Before Session 3: Mentorship & Professional Connections

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Think of one person, even a tentative guess, who could serve as a genuine mentor — someone with relevant experience and plausible willingness to invest time.
- This is the final session of the stage; come ready to reflect back across all three sessions, not just this one.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Having a specific person in mind, even a loose guess, turns FIRSTS N21-N24 from an abstract exercise into real, actionable next steps.